



Apple iPad 2

Apple rules the tablet roost, and if you have no real budget, you just cannot get a better tablet than the iPad. Even if another tablet does overtake it on the performance front, the sheer amount of apps available would still win it at least a Best Buy Award

Price: ₹36,900



Tablets

Tablets as a device still evoke extreme reactions. It isn't really a case of the traditional love it-hate it reaction, but more of a want it-see no purpose scenario. However, that hasn't stopped the market from being flooded with a slew of tablets all out to take on that one elusive market leader, the Apple iPad.

Simply put, there are two OSes in the battlefield – Apple's iOS and Google's Android, with WebOS out of the picture and Windows yet to make any solid appearance. Just like in the smartphone segment, one iOS device is fighting against literally a dozen Android tablets. And it's doing quite well in the battle, as the latest IDC figures suggest – the iPad has 68 per cent tablet market share while Android has just 27 per cent.

The year 2011 saw the demise of HP's WebOS from the tablet market, but looking forward to 2012, we'll see a slew of Windows tablets. Going by what we've experienced with Windows Phone 7 post the Mango update, expectations are high. Android is finding it tougher than expected to match the experience offered by the iOS, with constant efforts to reach that goal. This struggle has been surprising, but also a validation of Apple's "closed" environment theory.



Samsung Galaxy Tab 750

Price: ₹36,200



Motorola Xoom

Price: ₹35,000

Zero1 Winner

Apple iPad 2

There really was no doubt about this one. The iPad 2 was built on the good work of the first gen version, and offered more power in a slimmer package. At the same time, it kept features like the display the same as the previous one, following the adage of "if it ain't broke, don't fix it". Keeping the OS largely similar, Apple has ensured support for most iPhone apps on the tablet as well. And unlike Android, the "made for tablet" apps were available quickly, and in larger numbers. Plenty of Android tablets around, but buy this if you want *the* best tablet in the market.

Worthy Mentions

Samsung Galaxy Tab 750

After much teeth-gnashing and hair-pulling, finally one tablet emerges from the Android stable that's well and truly capable of going up to the iPad 2 and not get an inferiority complex. And the Tab 750 is even slimmer than the iPad 2! Of all the Android tablets that we've tested, this one has a far superior performance. If you're hellbent on buying an Android tablet, this is the one you should strongly consider.

Detailed review: <http://goo.gl/YtOrQ>

Motorola Xoom

If for some reason you don't really like the Samsung Galaxy Tab 750, there's a very capable alternative in the Motorola Xoom. It performs well, has a good build quality with some unique design elements and in general, feels worth the price. The only real niggle is that it feels bulky in the company of such slim tablets!

Detailed review: <http://goo.gl/IpEBn>

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